HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 3

VIGILLINE DAILY

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Novartis stands by its $12 billion Avidity bet after a $1.9 billion impairment

A charge on a failed late-stage neuromuscular asset and a public reaffirmation of the deal sit in the same disclosure. The chief executive's words describe the transaction, not the science behind it.

Novartis has disclosed a $1.9 billion impairment charge on a failed late-stage neuromuscular disease asset, and Vas Narasimhan, its chief executive, said the $12 billion acquisition of Avidity Biosciences “remains absolutely on track”, Endpoints News reported.

The pairing is the substance of the story for anyone assessing large-pharma deal discipline. An impairment is an accounting recognition that cash flows once expected will not arrive; a reaffirmation is a statement of intent about a transaction the company has already committed to. The two numbers are reported together because the first raises a question about the second.

What the reaffirmation does not do is price the assets. “On track” describes process — that the transaction proceeds on its agreed terms — rather than evidence that the programmes inside it have met their endpoints. A reader tracking RNA-directed platforms should keep the charge and the commitment as separate facts: one is a write-down against a specific late-stage programme, the other a statement about a deal.

The material reviewed does not name the failed asset or the trial it failed in, does not give the timing of the charge, and does not set out the structure of the Avidity transaction or any conditions still outstanding. VigilLine is not reporting figures or dates that the source does not state; the size of the write-down relative to the purchase price is therefore not something this issue can calculate.

IN NUMBERS

$12 billion

value of Novartis’s acquisition of Avidity Biosciences, which its chief executive said remains “absolutely on track”

$1.3825 billion

maximum value of Ferring’s agreement to acquire the fertility startup Gameto

₹1,200-1,300 crore

valuation implied for Sabine in Indira IVF’s acquisition talks, per ET HealthWorld

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ENDPOINTS NEWS

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Indoco Remedies’ AnaCipher wins ANVISA approval for clinical and bioanalytical facilities
EXPRESS PHARMA

BRIEFS

Draft Treasury rules could sharply curtail US-China biotech deals

Draft regulations from the US Treasury Department have opened an intense debate over the future of China biotech collaborations, which could be sharply curtailed under the proposal as written, Endpoints News reported. The summary reviewed does not complete the rule’s terms or give a consultation timetable.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

FDA gives new detail on a faster approval route for personalised gene therapies

The FDA has offered new details of a quicker approval pathway for personalised gene therapies, a move that rare disease advocates applauded as speeding access to treatment, STAT reported. The material reviewed does not give the pathway’s evidentiary standard, the therapies it covers or when it takes effect.

STAT NEWS

Outpace Bio ends a Phase 1 ovarian cancer trial of its mesothelin CAR-T

Outpace Bio has stopped a Phase 1 trial in ovarian cancer of OPB-101 (its mesothelin-directed autologous CAR-T), Endpoints News reported. The material reviewed does not give a reason for the decision, the number of patients treated or the dose levels reached.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Ferring agrees to buy the fertility startup Gameto for up to $1.3825 billion

Ferring Pharmaceuticals has signed an agreement to acquire Gameto, the “ovary-in-a-dish” fertility startup, in a deal that could be worth up to $1.3825 billion, the companies told Endpoints News. The material reviewed does not give the split between upfront and contingent payments, or a closing date.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Indira IVF in talks to buy Sabine at a valuation of ₹1,200-1,300 crore

Indira IVF is in talks to acquire Sabine, valuing the CX Partners-owned business at ₹1,200-1,300 crore, people familiar with the transaction told ET HealthWorld. CX Partners bought about 54% of Sabine in 2024 at a valuation of $100 million, about ₹835 crore. No signing date was given.

ET HEALTHWORLD

Anthropic acquires the drug discovery startup Mithril Medicine

Anthropic has acquired Mithril Medicine, a drug discovery company backed by Atlas Venture, as part of the AI firm’s push into the life sciences, Endpoints News reported. The material reviewed describes Mithril as a single-person startup and gives neither the purchase price nor the deal’s structure.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

SOURCES

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